

expected to liberalise the ecosystem as such companies accelerate partnerships. Also, it will generate new jobs such as testing pilots, engineers, etc.," says Amandeep Panwar, Co-Founder and Director of agri-tech firm BharatRohan. But he adds that the Competition Commission of India and the government should not encourage a monopoly.

Priyanka Agarwal Chopra, Managing Partner at start-up incubator IIMA Ventures, says Google's entry could have a multiplier effect. "With the entry of a big company into the picture, newer technologies are expected to be introduced. Also, India will find a place on the global map of the drone industry, opening up new opportunities for existing start-ups," she says. There are some who have expressed fears, considering Google's conflict with some internet-based businesses over its billing policy.

22 | ideaForge's CEO and Co-founder Ankit Mehta says that there's no need for any organisation to feel threatened since it is a highly use-case specific technology. "As drones are used across agriculture, videography, defence, land mapping, etc., no one company can pose a threat to the entire ecosystem," he says.

Further, Vikram Ramasubramanian, Partner at start-up investment platform Inflection Point Ventures, says there's definitely room for more companies to enter. He says there are 30-40 drone companies that have approached his firm for funding. "Adoption will automatically get a boost if a tech giant ventures into the space because such a company will bring with it an entire ecosystem, from manufacturing technologies to global connections and projects," Ramasubramanian adds.

The sector can, perhaps, rightfully expect heightened interest now. **BT**

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CRICKET

A Sporting Chance

The T20 World Cup has received a warm welcome in the US, but it needs big backing from advertisers

BY KRISHNA GOPALAN



PUSHING BOUNDARIES The India-Pakistan T20 match in New York drew big crowds as the US hosted the cricket World Cup for the first time

► **A CRICKET MATCH** between India and Pakistan is always highly anticipated, particularly if the encounter is part of a World Cup—not just their fans, but broadcasters and sponsors get excited, too. The recent ICC Men's T20 World Cup clash between the

neighbours in New York was no exception. It was a full house at the 34,000-seat Nassau County International Cricket Stadium in Eisenhower Park, and millions more tuned in to watch the broadcast worldwide.

While the numbers are quite

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